



Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development





INDIGENOUS LANGUAGE GRADE 4



Background

Kenya has many indigenous languages, not just the regional languages of the 42 counties but also the languages of Kenyans of unique backgrounds such as the Asians and many others. There are also social status languages such as Kiswahili based Sheng, English based Sheng and Engsh. Githinji 2006:10 – 11)



Cont.

For this reason, the constitution of Kenya chapter 2, article 7 (3) commits the Government to promote and protect the diversity of languages of the people of Kenya and promote the development and use of these languages. Scholarly perspectives that support the recognition of all languages include Mazrui and Mazrui's reference to Right of language and right to language and Ludwig's statement "the limits of my language are the limits of my world."



Cont.

Learning mother tongue provides opportunities for nurturing acceptance and appreciation of cultural diversity. The knowledge and skills acquired at this level will support cognitive and learning development at higher levels. Continuous advancement of knowledge in indigenous languages could guide learners to make decisions on future career choices such as acting, broadcasting, development of orthography, translation and interpretation among others. Overall, learning indigenous language ensures enhanced learning and inclusivity in a big way.



Essence Statement

This learning area develops the language skills acquired in EYE as well as a positive attitude towards learning. Having been exposed to concrete learning activities and basic literacy skills in lower primary, the learners' thought processes are more mature. Learners will therefore be provided with a rich and supportive environment to develop their proficiency in indigenous language. They will also be equipped with language skills to enable them acquire a second language more proficiently and achieve relevant competences. In addition, learning in a language they are already familiar with will give the learners the required confidence to express themselves clearly, participate more actively in the learning process and think critically as well as imaginatively.



Cont.

The indigenous language will further enable learners to interact effectively with peers, teachers and instructional materials, thus enhancing their cognitive and affective development. This resonates with Vygotsky's social cultural development theory which asserts that learning is majorly a social activity. Continuous advancement of knowledge in indigenous languages could guide learners to make decisions on future career choices such as acting, broadcasting, development of orthography and editing among others.



Subject General Learning Outcomes

By the end of middle school the learner should be able to:

- a) Respond appropriately to a variety of communication in the indigenous language
- b) Express themselves confidently and appropriately in a variety of social contexts
- c) Comprehend information in different contexts in the indigenous language
- d) Read texts accurately and fluently with comprehension
- e) Write legibly in different formats to express a variety of ideas and opinions
- f) Enjoy communicating using a variety of cultural language strategies



THEMES

1. School & Family
2. Care of animals
3. Means of communication (Etiquette in telephone conversations)
4. Safety & security
5. Modern means of transport
6. Occupations



Cont. Themes

- 7. Care of communal resources
- 8. Honesty
- 9. Disposal of technological waste
- 10. Modern means of transport
- 11. Peace education
- 12. Negative cultural practices



Strands

The four strands in the English Grade Four Curriculum Design are:

- Listening
- Speaking
- Reading
- Writing



Sub strands

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LISTENING	SPEAKING	READING	WRITING
❖ Listening to respond ❖ Listening to use information ❖ Listening to make personal opinions and judgements ❖ Listening comprehension ❖ Listening to stories on varied topics ❖ Listening to narrations with cultural language: proverbs/sayings	❖ Using specific language to give information ❖ Giving instructions ❖ Describing events and experiences ❖ Giving information on varied topics ❖ Discussing varied topics fluently and coherently ❖ Using artistic expressions to give imaginative experiences ❖ Telling stories ❖ Using correct pronunciation, intonation and pause	❖ Reading to use information ❖ Reading texts with varied language structures ❖ Silent reading(using level dictionary) ❖ Reading texts with a variety of literary short forms ❖ Reading texts for comprehension ❖ Reading texts on varied topical issues ❖ Reading to make personal judgements and opinions	❖ Writing using different sentence structures ❖ Using punctuation marks correctly in writing varied texts ❖ Using acquired vocabulary to give information ❖ Using artistic expressions to write stories and imaginative experiences



Facilitating Learning

Oral Skills

- ❖ Stress/Intonation
- ❖ Speaking Fluency
- ❖ Interactive Listening/Turn Taking/Riddles
- ❖ Listening Fluency
- ❖ Formulaic language: proverbs/sayings

Suggested Method

- **Dictogloss:** this is a type of dictation that involves the following:
- **Modelled speaking and listening**
- **Readers theatre :** Give opportunities for children to act as a narrator or character. For example, children could divide themselves into groups of four. Each member reads a particular stanza of a poem or paragraph of a narrative.
- **Retell/recounts:** Children retell narratives, memories or anything they can remember
- **Dramatic techniques :** Simulation, role-play, drama, hot seating and games have the same purpose or role in the language classroom. They help connect the classroom and the real world.
- **Language games**



What is different?

Listening & speaking

- ❖ Emphasis will be on pronunciation of sounds and blends that are unique to the indigenous languages.

Suggested Method

Language exposure: Listening and speaking activities to expose learners to actual sounds of their language and not those in Kiswahili or English

Practice in fluency : articulation of sounds correctly, with correct intonation and pause. This may include listening to recorded clips or speakers of the language to capture authentic pronunciation



Cont.

Reading & Writing

❖ Reading:

1. Reading texts with cultural language use for exposure
2. Intensive reading
3. Extensive reading

❖ Writing:

1. Writing using correct spelling
2. Using acquired language to give information in different formats
3. Creative Writing: Narrative
Compositions, using cultural language forms
such as proverbs/sayings

Suggested Methods

Reading

Reading structured paragraphs, reading words, sentences or texts with distinct sounds, reading texts with cultural language forms with comprehension. Creating own collection of vocabulary.

Writing

- Spelling practice
- Writing on varied topics using specific language structures
- Writing in logical sequence
- Writing creatively using proverbs, sayings and expressions unique to the language.



Cont.

Think globally, act locally

Discussing creative forms, technology, health, music and art from the indigenous point of view and discovering linguistic equivalents.

Approaches

Local songs, poetry, riddles and language games will be used to enhance proficiency. The emphasis will be on learning authentic indigenous language forms of creativity and not foreign or exotic creations of Shakespeare or Shaban Robert. The African folk songs, chants will form the basis of creative language learning.



Thank you